

Avika Gor, 11*Anandi on Balika Vadhu, Colors*

Most children would throw a tantrum if they had to do anything other than play on a Sunday. But Avika Gor isn't just another 11-year-old. She plays Anandi, the child bride on *Balika Vadhu*. Racing past Tulsi and Parvati, Gor became everyone's favourite bahu within a month of the show's launch. Bit roles in *Karam Apna Apna* and *Rajkumar Aaryan* followed but none as stupendous as *Balika Vadhu*. Between working close to eight hours daily for which she takes home Rs 6,000 to Rs 8,000 per episode, Gor endorses Today pens and Sparkle Jewellery and recently walked the ramp for them. It's a stretch to expect the mini-celebrity to have play and study time like others, but her parents, who are insurance agents, cart her books and complete chapters between shots. Gor has also done two films—*Morning Walk* with Anupam Kher and Sharmila Tagore and *Paathshaala* with Shahid Kapoor. "I had the most fun with Shahid," says Gor, clearly star-struck.

TV'S FRESH FACE

Girls in peril replace bahus bathed in bathos as scandal makes way for social purpose on prime time TV

| By Jhilmil Motihar |

The Colors office in Andheri (East) has had a love-hate relationship with Wednesdays. This is the day when weekly ratings on how the channel is performing are released. When Colors, soon after its launch in July 2008, started climbing the charts, excitement prevailed. Euphoria would be the right description when the channel surpassed Zee TV to reach number two in September 2008. But for the last two months, anxiety and frustration had taken over. The channel inched close to big daddy Star Plus' number one position several times but missed it by a whisker. After weeks of waiting, watching and wringing of hands, the channel finally broke Star Plus' nine-year reign. In the week of April 5 to 11, Colors bagged 24 per cent of the total general entertainment channel (GEC) share, while Star Plus lagged behind with 22 per cent. The passing of the baton in the Hindi GEC space is not just symbolic. The rumblings of change have been gaining momentum for quite a while. It crystallised in the form of Anandi,